INDO-PACIFIC, INDIAN OCEAN AND MARITIME SECURITY

CENTRAL MARITIME QUESTION AND → DOCTRINE LADDER: SAGAR TO → LEGAL-STATUS LADDER IN THE → THREE DISTINCT MECHANISMS, THREE → INDIA'S OWN CAPABILITY INSTRUMENTS → MALDIVES INSTRUMENT PRICED COMPONENT

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

CENTRAL MARITIME QUESTION AND ITS ROOT DEPENDENCE

CENTRAL MARITIME QUESTION AND ITS ROOT DEPENDENCE · HOW DOES INDIA SECURE A MARITIME SPACE IT DOES · ROOT CONDITION · MORE THAN HALF OF INDIA'S TRADE TRAVERSES THE STRAIT · 26/11 TERRORISTS HIJACKED AN INDIAN FISHING VESSEL · AXIS 1 · UNCLOS RATIFIED 29 JUNE 1995; BBNJ SIGNED 25 SEPTEMBER · AXIS 2

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

- CENTRAL QUESTION → how does India secure a maritime space it does not control?
- ROOT CONDITION → more than half of India's trade traverses the Strait of Malacca + formative shock: 26/11 terrorists hijacked an Indian fishing vessel

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

- AXIS 1 → RULES: UNCLOS ratified 29 June 1995; BBNJ signed 25 September 2024
- AXIS 2 → AWARENESS: IFC-IOR 2018, Gurugram; IORA; IONS 2008

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

- AXIS 3 → PARTNERS: island-state vision documents; non-treaty minilaterals
- RULE → dependence is the premise: every later instrument answers it

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → dependence is the premise; every later instrument answers it.

01

STAGE 01

DOCTRINE LADDER: SAGAR TO MAHASAGAR

DOCTRINE LADDER · SAGAR TO MAHASAGAR · 12 MARCH 2015, MAURITIUS · SECURITY AND GROWTH FOR ALL IN THE REGION SECURITY · 12 MARCH 2025, PORT LOUIS · MUTUAL AND HOLISTIC ADVANCEMENT FOR · SECURITY AND GROWTH ACROSS REGIONS; TRADE FOR DEVELOPMENT; CAPACITY · MUTUAL SECURITY; TECHNOLOGY SHARING, CONCESSIONAL LOAN AND GRANTS

12 MARCH 2015, MAURITIUS → SAGAR: Security and Growth for All in the Region security

12 MARCH 2025, PORT LOUIS → MAHASAGAR: Mutual and Holistic Advancement for → **Security and Growth Across Regions; trade for development; capacity building** → **mutual security; technology sharing, concessional loan and grants**

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

- 12 MARCH 2015, MAURITIUS → SAGAR: Security and Growth for All in the Region security cooperation + economic and developmental partnership
- 12 MARCH 2025, PORT LOUIS → MAHASAGAR: Mutual and Holistic Advancement for

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

- Security and Growth Across Regions; trade for development; capacity building
- mutual security; technology sharing, concessional loan and grants

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

- SAME SPEECH → India is moving ahead with the SAGAR Vision
- LIMIT → extension of scope to the Global South; declared vision, not a treaty

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → extension of scope to the Global South; declared vision, not a treaty.

02

STAGE 02

LEGAL-STATUS LADDER IN THE MARITIME ORDER

LEGAL-STATUS LADDER IN THE MARITIME ORDER · 10 DECEMBER 1982 · INDIA SIGNS THE CONVENTION ON THE LAW OF THE · 29 JUNE 1995 · INDIA RATIFIES; DOMESTIC ZONES UNDER THE 1976 MARITIME ZONES · 19 JUNE 2023 · BBNJ ADOPTED · 20 SEPTEMBER 2023

10 DECEMBER 1982 → India signs the Convention on the Law of the Sea

29 JUNE 1995: India ratifies; domestic zones under the 1976 Maritime Zones Act → **19 JUNE 2023: BBNJ adopted → 20 SEPTEMBER 2023: opened for signature** → **25 SEPTEMBER 2024: India signs → 19 SEPTEMBER 2025: 60th ratification lodged**

DATED OFFICIAL INSTRUMENT

- 10 DECEMBER 1982 → India signs the Convention on the Law of the Sea
- 29 JUNE 1995: India ratifies; domestic zones under the 1976 Maritime Zones Act
- 19 JUNE 2023: BBNJ adopted → 20 SEPTEMBER 2023: opened for signature

EVIDENTIARY LEVEL IT REACHES

- 25 SEPTEMBER 2024: India signs → 19 SEPTEMBER 2025: 60th ratification lodged
- 17 JANUARY 2026: BBNJ enters into force
- STATUS → India is a signatory and not a party as of 3 August 2026

STATUS / CLAIM LIMIT

- COST → a non-party cannot vote at the Conference of the Parties

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COST → a non-party cannot vote at the Conference of the Parties.

03

STAGE 03

THREE DISTINCT MECHANISMS, THREE DISTINCT FUNCTIONS

THREE DISTINCT MECHANISMS, THREE DISTINCT FUNCTIONS · REGIONAL INTERGOVERNMENTAL ORGANISATION; 23 MEMBERS; 12 DIALOGUE PARTNERS · SECRETARIAT AT EBENE, MAURITIUS; INDIA CHAIRS 2025–27 FROM NOVEMBER · VOLUNTARY NAVAL-COOPERATION SYMPOSIUM, ESTABLISHED 2008 · INDIA ASSUMED THE CHAIR ON 20 FEBRUARY 2026 · INDIAN NAVY INFORMATION-FUSION CENTRE, 2018, GURUGRAM, NOVEMBER 2025 · 25 PARTNER COUNTRIES AND INTERNATIONAL LIAISON OFFICERS FROM 15 · THREE SEPARATE BODIES, NEVER INTERCHANGEABLE NAMES FOR ONE MECHANISM

ACTOR / INTEREST	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	STATUS TRAP / LIMIT
IORA → regional intergovernmental organisation; 23 members; 12 dialogue partners	India assumed the chair on 20 February 2026	TRAP → three separate bodies, never interchangeable names for one mechanism
Secretariat at Ebene, Mauritius; India chairs 2025–27 from November 2025	IFC-IOR → Indian Navy information-fusion centre, 2018, Gurugram; November 2025	LIMIT → a chairship is agenda-setting and convening power, not control
IONS → voluntary naval-cooperation symposium, established 2008	25 partner countries and International Liaison Officers from 15 countries	

ACTOR / INTEREST

- IORA → regional intergovernmental organisation; 23 members; 12 dialogue partners
- Secretariat at Ebene, Mauritius; India chairs 2025–27 from November 2025
- IONS → voluntary naval-cooperation symposium, established 2008

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- India assumed the chair on 20 February 2026
- IFC-IOR → Indian Navy information-fusion centre, 2018, Gurugram; November 2025
- 25 partner countries and International Liaison Officers from 15 countries

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

- TRAP → three separate bodies, never interchangeable names for one mechanism
- LIMIT → a chairship is agenda-setting and convening power, not control

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → three separate bodies, never interchangeable names for one mechanism.

04

STAGE 04

INDIA'S OWN CAPABILITY INSTRUMENTS

INDIA'S OWN CAPABILITY INSTRUMENTS · FAR EASTERN NAVAL COMMAND · PORT BLAIR, CITED AS A REGIONAL ENGAGEMENT INSTRUMENT · BIENNIAL NAVAL-FLEET GATHERING RUNNING SINCE 1995 · MULTILATERAL ANTI-PIRACY COOPERATION INDIA ACTIVELY PARTICIPATES IN · SAGAR PRAHARI BAL · INDIAN NAVY FORCE RAISED IN 2009 FOR BASE AND · OPERATIONS ROUTE TO THE INTERNAL SECURITY MARITIME AND COASTAL

ACTOR / INTEREST	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	STATUS TRAP / LIMIT
FAR EASTERN NAVAL COMMAND → Port Blair, cited as a regional engagement instrument	ReCAAP → multilateral anti-piracy cooperation India actively participates in	BOUNDARY → operations route to the Internal Security maritime and coastal owner
MILAN → biennial naval-fleet gathering running since 1995	SAGAR PRAHARI BAL → Indian Navy force raised in 2009 for base and vulnerable-point protection	FAR EASTERN NAVAL COMMAND → Port Blair, cited as a regional engagement instrument

ACTOR / INTEREST

- FAR EASTERN NAVAL COMMAND → Port Blair, cited as a regional engagement instrument
- MILAN → biennial naval-fleet gathering running since 1995

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- ReCAAP → multilateral anti-piracy cooperation India actively participates in
- SAGAR PRAHARI BAL → Indian Navy force raised in 2009 for base and vulnerable-point protection

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

- BOUNDARY → operations route to the Internal Security maritime and coastal owner
- FAR EASTERN NAVAL COMMAND → Port Blair, cited as a regional engagement instrument

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BOUNDARY → operations route to the Internal Security maritime and coastal owner.

05

STAGE 05

MALDIVES INSTRUMENT PRICED COMPONENT BY COMPONENT

MALDIVES INSTRUMENT PRICED COMPONENT BY COMPONENT · 7 OCTOBER 2024 · INDIA–MALDIVES JOINT VISION FOR COMPREHENSIVE ECONOMIC AND · MARITIME SECURITY PARTNERSHIP · USD 400 MILLION + INR 30 BILLION · CURRENCY-SWAP ARRANGEMENT · ARRANGED FACILITY, NOT EVIDENCE OF DRAWDOWN · 25 JULY 2025

ACTOR / INTEREST	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	STATUS TRAP / LIMIT
7 OCTOBER 2024 → India–Maldives Joint Vision for Comprehensive Economic and	LEVEL: arranged facility, not evidence of drawdown	LEVEL → Terms of Reference launch talks; they do not conclude an agreement
Maritime Security Partnership	25 JULY 2025 → FTA Terms of Reference signed and negotiations launched	READING → India answered political distance with more instruments, not fewer
USD 400 MILLION + INR 30 BILLION → currency-swap arrangement	INR 4,850 crore Line of Credit	

ACTOR / INTEREST

- 7 OCTOBER 2024 → India–Maldives Joint Vision for Comprehensive Economic and
- Maritime Security Partnership
- USD 400 MILLION + INR 30 BILLION → currency-swap arrangement

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- LEVEL: arranged facility, not evidence of drawdown
- 25 JULY 2025 → FTA Terms of Reference signed and negotiations launched
- INR 4,850 crore Line of Credit

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

- LEVEL → Terms of Reference launch talks; they do not conclude an agreement
- READING → India answered political distance with more instruments, not fewer

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: READING → India answered political distance with more instruments, not fewer.

06

STAGE 06

COLOMBO SECURITY CONCLAVE CATEGORY MATRIX

COLOMBO SECURITY CONCLAVE CATEGORY MATRIX · STATUS ON 20 NOVEMBER 2025, NEW DELHI, NSA-LEVEL MEETING · SRI LANKA · 9 FEBRUARY 2026 · INDIA WELCOMED SEYCHELLES' DECISION TO BECOME A FULL MEMBER · NO OFFICIALLY RECORDED EFFECTIVE ACCESSION DATE · MEMBER, OBSERVER, GUEST AND DECIDED TO JOIN ARE FOUR

OBSERVER	Seychelles
GUEST	Malaysia

ACTOR / INTEREST

- STATUS ON 20 NOVEMBER 2025, NEW DELHI, NSA-LEVEL MEETING
- Sri Lanka

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- 9 FEBRUARY 2026 → India welcomed Seychelles' decision to become a full member
- MISSING → no officially recorded effective accession date

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

- TRAP → member, observer, guest and decided to join are four separate claims
- STATUS ON 20 NOVEMBER 2025, NEW DELHI, NSA-LEVEL MEETING

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → member, observer, guest and decided to join are four separate claims.

07

STAGE 07

INDO-PACIFIC ARCHITECTURE AND ITS SEVEN PILLARS

INDO-PACIFIC ARCHITECTURE AND ITS SEVEN PILLARS · 4 NOVEMBER 2019, BANGKOK, 14TH EAST ASIA SUMMIT · INDO-PACIFIC OCEANS INITIATIVE · MARITIME SECURITY · MARITIME ECOLOGY · MARITIME RESOURCES CAPACITY BUILDING AND RESOURCE SHARING · DISASTER-RISK REDUCTION AND MANAGEMENT SCIENCE, TECHNOLOGY AND ACADEMIC COOPERATION · TRADE, CONNECTIVITY, MARITIME TRANSPORT

4 NOVEMBER 2019, BANGKOK, 14th EAST ASIA SUMMIT → Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative → **PILLARS → maritime security** → **maritime ecology** → **maritime resources capacity building and resource sharing** → **disaster-risk reduction and management science, technology and academic cooperation**

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

- 4 NOVEMBER 2019, BANGKOK, 14th EAST ASIA SUMMIT → Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative
- PILLARS → maritime security
- maritime ecology

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

- maritime resources capacity building and resource sharing
- disaster-risk reduction and management science, technology and academic cooperation
- trade, connectivity, maritime transport

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

- ASEAN CENTRALITY → the Initiative and the ASEAN Outlook are complementary
- FORUMS → East Asia Summit is leaders-led; ASEAN Regional Forum builds confidence
- LIMIT → not a treaty, alliance or centralised funding body; weak enforcement

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → not a treaty, alliance or centralised funding body; weak enforcement.

08

STAGE 08

MINILATERAL CAPABILITY AGAINST STRUCTURAL ASYMMETRY

MINILATERAL CAPABILITY AGAINST STRUCTURAL ASYMMETRY · INDIA–US EXERCISE; JAPAN ADDED; REGULAR AUSTRALIAN PARTICIPATION FROM 2020 · INTEROPERABILITY AMONG ALL FOUR QUADRILATERAL STATES · DOES NOT PROVE · ANY COLLECTIVE-DEFENCE OBLIGATION · THAROOR'S ASYMMETRY · WASHINGTON HOLDS LONG-ESTABLISHED TREATY RELATIONSHIPS THAT OTHER MEMBERS, INDIA · THE GROUPING SUPPLEMENTS INDIAN CAPACITY; IT NEVER SUBSTITUTES FOR

ACTOR / INTEREST	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	STATUS TRAP / LIMIT
MALABAR → India–US exercise; Japan added; regular Australian participation from 2020	DOES NOT PROVE: any collective-defence obligation	CONSEQUENCE → the grouping supplements Indian capacity; it never substitutes for it
PROVES: interoperability among all four Quadrilateral states	THAROOR'S ASYMMETRY → Washington holds long-established treaty relationships that other members, India included, do not share among themselves	OWNERSHIP → the grouping's institutional profile belongs to topic 10

ACTOR / INTEREST

- MALABAR → India–US exercise; Japan added; regular Australian participation from 2020
- PROVES: interoperability among all four Quadrilateral states

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- DOES NOT PROVE: any collective-defence obligation
- THAROOR'S ASYMMETRY → Washington holds long-established treaty relationships that other members, India included, do not share among themselves

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

- CONSEQUENCE → the grouping supplements Indian capacity; it never substitutes for it
- OWNERSHIP → the grouping's institutional profile belongs to topic 10

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OWNERSHIP → the grouping's institutional profile belongs to topic 10.

09

STAGE 09

AUKUS PATHWAY AND ITS OPEN QUESTIONS

AUKUS PATHWAY AND ITS OPEN QUESTIONS · 15 SEPTEMBER 2021 · AUKUS ANNOUNCED BY AUSTRALIA, THE UK AND THE UNITED · TRACK 1 · CONVENTIONALLY ARMED, NUCLEAR-POWERED SUBMARINES FOR AUSTRALIA · TRACK 2 · CYBER, ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE, QUANTUM, FURTHER UNDERSEA CAPABILITIES · MARCH 2023 PATHWAY

15 SEPTEMBER 2021 → AUKUS announced by Australia, the UK and the United States → **TRACK 1 → conventionally armed, nuclear-powered submarines for Australia** → **TRACK 2 → cyber, artificial intelligence, quantum, further undersea capabilities** → **MARCH 2023 PATHWAY → rotational UK-US presence from as early as 2027** → **Virginia-class sale from the early 2030s subject to US approval; later SSN-AUKUS**

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

- 15 SEPTEMBER 2021 → AUKUS announced by Australia, the UK and the United States
- TRACK 1 → conventionally armed, nuclear-powered submarines for Australia
- TRACK 2 → cyber, artificial intelligence, quantum, further undersea capabilities

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

- MARCH 2023 PATHWAY → rotational UK-US presence from as early as 2027
- Virginia-class sale from the early 2030s subject to US approval; later SSN-AUKUS
- JUNE 2022 → EUR 555 million settlement over the cancelled French programme

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

- NOVEMBER 2025 → IAEA Article 14 safeguards arrangement still under negotiation
- INDIA → not an AUKUS member; its Quadrilateral route is parallel and non-treaty

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: INDIA → not an AUKUS member; its Quadrilateral route is parallel and non-treaty.

10

STAGE 10

SECTORAL RULE-MAKING AT THE INTERNATIONAL MARITIME ORGANIZATION

SECTORAL RULE-MAKING AT THE INTERNATIONAL MARITIME ORGANIZATION · 1948 CONVENTION ADOPTED · 1958 ENTRY INTO FORCE · UN SPECIALISED AGENCY · ASSEMBLY (ALL MEMBERS) · COUNCIL (EXECUTIVE) · MSC, MEPC, LEGAL, TC, FAL · BALLAST WATER MANAGEMENT, IN FORCE 2017

1948 CONVENTION ADOPTED → 1958 ENTRY INTO FORCE → UN specialised agency → **ORGANS → Assembly (all members)** → **Council (executive)** → **MSC, MEPC, Legal, TC, FAL** → **INSTRUMENTS → SOLAS**

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

- 1948 CONVENTION ADOPTED → 1958 ENTRY INTO FORCE → UN specialised agency
- ORGANS → Assembly (all members)
- Council (executive)
- MSC, MEPC, Legal, TC, FAL

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

- INSTRUMENTS → SOLAS
- Ballast Water Management, in force 2017
- Hong Kong ship recycling, in force 26 June 2025
- 1 JANUARY 2020 → global sulphur limit cut from 3.50% to 0.50% m/m

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

- 2023 GHG STRATEGY → net zero by or around 2050, with 2030 and 2040 checkpoints
- OCTOBER 2025 → Net-Zero Framework approved at committee level, NOT adopted; adjourned
- INDIA → elected to Council Category (b) for 2026-27; access, not guaranteed outcomes

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: INDIA → elected to Council Category (b) for 2026-27; access, not guaranteed outcomes.

11

STAGE 11

ANSWER SPINE FOR A MARITIME DEMAND

ANSWER SPINE FOR A MARITIME DEMAND · NAME THE SEA-LANE DEPENDENCE AND THE EXACT INTEREST IT · RULES, AWARENESS AND PARTNERS, EACH WITH ONE DATED INSTRUMENT · PRICE EXTERNAL-POWER BASING, ISLAND-STATE AGENCY AND MINILATERAL ASYMMETRY · QUALIFY THE NET SECURITY PROVIDER LABEL AND GIVE A

OPEN → name the sea-lane dependence and the exact interest it creates → **BUILD → rules, awareness and partners, each with one dated instrument at its level** → **TEST → price external-power basing, island-state agency and minilateral asymmetry** → **CLOSE → qualify the net security provider label and give a graded contested-order verdict**

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

- OPEN → name the sea-lane dependence and the exact interest it creates
- BUILD → rules, awareness and partners, each with one dated instrument at its level

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

- TEST → price external-power basing, island-state agency and minilateral asymmetry
- CLOSE → qualify the net security provider label and give a graded contested-order verdict

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

- OPEN → name the sea-lane dependence and the exact interest it creates
- BUILD → rules, awareness and partners, each with one dated instrument at its level

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → qualify the net security provider label and give a graded contested-order verdict.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · THE PRINCIPAL REGIONAL POLITICAL FORUM FOR LITTORAL-STATE · IONS (2008) · VOLUNTARY NAVAL-COOPERATION SYMPOSIUM AMONG INDIAN OCEAN · IFC-IOR (2018, GURUGRAM) · THE OPERATIONAL INFORMATION-SHARING LAYER FOR · SAGAR PRAHARI BAL (2009) · A SPECIALISED INDIAN NAVY FORCE FOR BASE AND ·

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE AND INSTRUMENT DEPTH

- IORA: the principal regional political forum for littoral-state
- IONS (2008): voluntary naval-cooperation symposium among Indian Ocean
- IFC-IOR (2018, Gurugram): the operational information-sharing layer for
- Sagar Prahari Bal (2009): a specialised Indian Navy force for base and

STATUS, DATE AND FIGURE LIMIT

- India–Maldives Vision for Comprehensive Economic and Maritime Security
- CAUTION: Quad's maritime-security dimension: a non-treaty, asymmetric coalition
- CAUTION: Colombo Security Conclave: a regional maritime and security-cooperation
- CAUTION: Route Internal Security (naval/anti-piracy operations) to

COMPARATIVE DIPLOMATIC NUANCE

- Direct PYQ boundary case (2024 Q20): the question explicitly asks about
- CAUTION: Boundary case — Maldives' own hedging: consistent with island-state
- CAUTION: Boundary case — chairship without control: India simultaneously chairs
- CAUTION: Boundary case — Quad asymmetry: Tharoor's point about unequal treaty

OPTIONAL STATUS — *This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.*

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels